

cross-Department System Owners

As GitLab has grown organically, several departments and functional groups have their own System Administrators ("System Owners") to handle day-to-day management of the tech stack applications that are specific to that department or functional group.

See the Business Technology handbook page to learn more about system owners.

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Introduction

Since GitLab is an all remote company we don't have a physical worksite or breakroom wall upon which to post important labor and employment notices, so this page is our version of that.

{{% details summary="GitLab, Inc. & GitLab Federal LLC" %}}

Alabama

- Child Labor Law
- Your Job Insurance - Unemployment Insurance
- Workers' Compensation Poster - Inc.

Alaska

- Safety and Health Protection on the Job
- Emergency Information
- Human Rights Law - Sexual Harassment
- Unemployment Insurance
- Summary of Alaska Child Labor Law
- Summary of Alaska Wage and Hour Act
- Alaska - Americans with Disabilities Act
- Alaska - Alcohol and Drug-free Workplace Policy
- State of Alaska Whistleblower Act

Arizona

- Constructive Discharge Notice
- Discrimination is Prohibited in Employment
- Earned Paid Sick Time
- Employee Safety and Health Protection
- 2024 Minimum Wage
- Unemployment Insurance
- Workers' Compensation - Inc.
- Bodily Fluids Work Exposure and Work Exposure to MRSA, Spinal Meningitis, or Tuberculosis

Arkansas

- Minimum Wage, Overtime, Child Labor, Wage Collection Notice
- How to Claim Unemployment Insurance
- Workers' Compensation Notice - Inc.

California

- California Law Prohibits Workplace Discrimination and Harassment
- Transgender Rights in the Workplace
- Your Rights and Obligations as a Pregnant Employee
- Family Care & Medical Leave & Pregnancy Disability Leave
- Industrial Welfare Commission Wage Order
- California Minimum Wage
- Paid Sick Leave.pdf)
- Safety and Health Protection on the Job
- Notice to Employees - Injuries Caused by Work
- Whistleblower Protections
- Notice to Employees - Unemployment, Disability, and Paid Family Leave insurance
- Notice to Employees - Unemployment Insurance Benefits
- Sexual Harassment Fact Sheet
- Supplemental Paid Sick Leave - COVID-19
- Payday Notice
- Right to Vote Notice
- Victims of Domestic Violence Leave Notice
- Workers' Compensation Notice - Inc.
- Employee Polygraph Protection Act
- City of Berkeley
 - Minimum Wage Poster
- City of Daly City
 - Minimum Wage Poster
- City of Emeryville
 - Minimum Wage and Paid Sick Leave
 - COVID-19 Paid Sick Leave
- City of Los Angeles
 - Fair Chance Initiative for Hiring Ordinance to Applicants and Employees
 - Minimum Wage and Paid Sick Leave
- Los Angeles County
 - Fair Chance Notice for Employers

- Minimum Wage Ordinance
- City of Oakland
 - Minimum Wage/Paid Sick Leave/Service Charge
- City of San Diego
 - Earned Sick Leave
 - Minimum Wage
 - Combination Poster
- City of San Jose
 - Minimum Wage Bulletin
 - Opportunity to Work Notice
- City of San Francisco
 - Minimum Wage Poster
 - Paid Sick Leave
 - Fair Chance Ordinance
 - Health Care Security Ordinance
 - Family Friendly Workplace Ordinance
 - Paid Parental Leave Ordinance
 - Salary History Ordinance
 - COVID-Related Employment Protections
 - Public Health Emergency Leave
- City of Santa Monica
 - Minimum Wage, Paid Sick Leave and Service Charge Law
- City of West Hollywood
 - Minimum Wage - English
 - Minimum Wage - Spanish

Colorado

- Employment Anti-Discrimination Poster
- Housing Anti-Discrimination Poster
- Public Accommodations Anti-Discrimination Poster
- Employment Security Act
- Overtime & Minimum Pay Standards
- Notice to Employer of Injury
- Notice of Paydays
- Workers' Compensation Act
- Paid Family and Medical Leave Insurance
- Paid Leave, Whistleblowing, and Personal Protective Equipment

Connecticut

- Sexual Harassment is Illegal
- Paid Sick Leave
- Paid Leave poster
- Discrimination is Illegal
- Minimum Wage
- Worker's Compensation Notice
- Electronic Monitoring Notice
- Office of the Healthcare Advocate
- Pregnancy Discrimination and Accommodation in the Workplace

Delaware

- Labor Law Poster
- Sexual Harasment Notice
- Respectful Workplace and Anti-Discrimination Policy

District of Columbia

- Paid Family Leave Employee Notice
- COVID-19 Leave Notice
- Equal Employment Opportunity
- DC Family and Medical Leave Act
- Right to Breastfeed
- Protecting Pregnant Workers Fairness Act
- Parental Leave Act
- Minimum Wage and Overtime
- Unemployment Compensation
- Accrued Sick and Safe Leave Act of 2008
- Living Wage Act

Florida

- Minimum Wage
- Florida Law Prohibits Discrimination
- Equal Opportunity is the Law
- Unemployment Compensation Benefits
- Workers' Compensation

Georgia

- Unemployment Insurance
- Vacation - Unemployment Insurance
- Workers' Compensation
- Bill of Rights for the Injured Worker
- Workers' Compensation Fraud
- Human Trafficking
- Equal Pay for Equal Work Act

Hawaii

- Labor Law Poster
- Disability Compensation Law
- Laws Prohibiting Employment Discrimination
- Occupational Health and Safety Laws
- Unemployment Insurance Law
- Required Notice to Dislocated Workers/Plant Closings

Idaho

- Equal Opportunity is the Law

- Idaho Law Prohibits Discrimination in Employment
- Minimum Wage
- Unemployment Insurance Benefits
- Workers' Compensation Notice - Inc.

Illinois

- Your Rights Under Illinois Employment Laws
- Victims' Economic Security and Safety Act (VESSA)
- Pregnancy Rights Notice
- Your Rights Under the Illinois Service Member Employment and Reemployment Rights Act
- Right to Employment Free from Discrimination and Sexual Harassment
- Workers' Compensation Notice - Inc.
- City of Chicago
 - Minimum Wage, Paid Sick Leave, Wage Theft and Human Trafficking
- Cook County
 - Earned Sick Leave Ordinance

Indiana

- Unemployment Insurance Claimant Handbook
- Job Safety and Health
- Minimum Wage
- Equal Employment Opportunity is the Law
- Workers' Compensation Notice - Federal
- Workers' Compensation Notice - Inc.

Iowa

- All in One
- Unemployment Insurance
- Safety and Health Protection on the Job
- Your Rights Under Iowa's Minimum Wage
- Equal Employment Opportunity
- Workers' Compensation Notice - Inc.
- Summary of Work-Related Injuries and Illnesses

Kansas

- Unemployment Insurance
- Kansas Law Provides Equal Opportunity
- Workers' Compensation Notice - Inc.

Kentucky

- Safety and Health on the Job
- Wage and Hour Laws
- Wage Discrimination Because of Sex
- Equal Employment Opportunity
- Unemployment Compensation Benefits

- Workers' Compensation Notice - Inc.

Louisiana

- Age Discrimination
- Genetic Discrimination
- Minor Labor Law Placard
- Out-of-State Motor Vehicles
- National Guard (ESGR) State Poster
- Pregnancy Rights of Employees
- Sickle Cell Trait Discrimination
- Timely Payment of Wages
- Unemployment Insurance
- Earned Income Credit
- Equal Opportunity of All
- Independent Contractor or Employee
- Workers' Compensation Notice - Inc.

Maine

- Minimum Wage
- Sexual Harassment
- Whistleblower's Protection Act
- Workers' Compensation
- Video Display Terminals
- Child Labor Laws
- Regulation of Employment
- Maine Employment Security Law

Maryland

- Employment Discrimination is Unlawful.pdf)
- Maryland Job Safety and Health
- Minimum Wage and Overtime Law
- Equal Pay for Equal Work
- Earned Sick and Safe Leave
- Unemployment Insurance Law
- Health Insurance Coverage
- Pregnancy Rights.pdf)
- Employment of Minors
- Montgomery County
 - Minimum Wage and Overtime Law
 - Earned Sick and Safe Leave

Massachusetts

- Paid Family and Medical Leave
- Earned Sick Time
- Massachusetts Wage and Hours Laws
- Fair Employment Law

- Sexual Harassment
- Workers' Compensation Notice - Federal
- Workers' Compensation Notice - Inc.

Michigan

- Unemployment Benefits
- Michigan Law Prohibits Discrimination
- Minimum Wage and Overtime
- Paid Medical Leave
- Child Labor
- Safety and Health Protection on the Job
- Whistleblower Protection

Minnesota

- Age Discrimination
- Minimum Wage
- Safety and Health Protection on the Job
- Unemployment Insurance
- Workers' Compensation Notice - Inc.
- Labor and Employment Rights
- Earned Sick and Safe Time
- Nursing Mothers, Lactating Employees, and Pregnancy Accommodations Notice
- City of Duluth
 - Earned Sick and Safe Time
- City of Minneapolis
 - Labor and Employment Rights
- City of Saint Paul
 - Earned Sick and Safe Time and Minimum Wage
- City of Bloomington
 - Earned Sick and Safe Time

Mississippi

- Unemployment Insurance
- Workers' Compensation Notice - Inc.

Missouri

- Discrimination in Employment
- Notice to Victims of Domestic and Sexual Violence - Leave Time Allowed
- Missouri Minimum Wage Law
- Workers' Compensation Notice - Inc.

Montana

- Montana Wage & Hour - English
- Montana Wage & Hour - Spanish
- Workers' Compensation Notice - Inc.

Nebraska

- Nebraska Minimum Wage
- Discrimination in Employment
- Unemployment Insurance Advisement of Benefit Rights
- Job Safety and Health
- Workers' Compensation Notice - Inc.

Nevada

- Rules to be Observed by Employers - English
- Reglas para ser Observadas por Los Empleadores
- AB 190 - English
- AB 190 - Spanish
- AB 307 - English
- AB 307 - Spanish.pdf)
- SB 209 - English
- SB 209 - Spanish
- Notice of Limitations Affecting the Application of Lie Detector Tests
- Aviso de Limitaciones que Afectan La Aplicacion de Pruebas de Deteccion de Mentiras
- Domestic Violence Bulletin
- Boletín de Víctimas de Violencia Doméstica
- SB 312 Paid Leave - English.pdf)
- SB 312 Permiso Remunerado
- Annual Minimum Wage Bulletin.pdf)
- Boletín Anual Salario Minimo.pdf)
- Annual Bulletin - Daily Overtime
- Boletín Anual Tiempo Extra Diario
- Information for the Unemployed Worker
- Nevada Law Prohibits Discrimination
- La Ley de Nevada Prohibe La Discriminación
- Notice to Employer that Employee is Sick or Sustained Injury
- Aviso al empleador de enfermedad o lesión del empleado.pdf)
- Nursing Mothers Accommodation Act
- Ley de Acomodamiento para Madres que Amamantan.pdf)
- Pregnant Workers Fairness Act
- Ley de Equidad de Trabajadoras Embarazadas
- Workers' Compensation

New Hampshire

- Protective Legislation Law
- Criteria to Establish an Employee or Independent Contractor
- Minimum Wage Law
- Whistleblowers Protection Act
- Workers' Right to Know
- Equal Pay Law
- Unemployment Notice
- Employment Discrimination is Against the Law
- Workers' Compensation Notice - Inc.

- Optional Paid Family and Medical Leave Insurance

New Jersey

- New Jersey Earned Sick Leave%20BLUE%2011x17%20Sick%20Leave%20poster-English.pdf)
 - Employers benefit year is Jan 1 - Dec 31
- Wage and Hour Law Abstract%20Wage%20Hour%20Abstract%20Poster.pdf)
- Child Labor Law
- Employer Obligation to Maintain and Report Records
- Payment of Wages.pdf)
- Family Leave Insurance
- Unemployment & Temporary Disability Insurance
- CEPA Whistleblower Act
- New Jersey Safe Act
- Gender Equity Notice

Public Employees Occupational Safety and Health

- New Jersey Misclassification Notice
- The Law Against Discrimination (LAD) Prohibits Discrimination and Harassment
- The New Jersey Family Leave Act (NJFLA)
- Workers' Compensation Notice - Inc.
- Workers' Compensation Notice - Federal

New Mexico

- Minimum Wage
- Human Rights Act
- Human Trafficking Poster
- Job Safety and Health Poster
- Notice of Accident or Occupational Disease Disablement
- Paid Sick Leave

Bernalillo County

- Employee Wellness Act

New York

- New York Correction Law, Article 23-A
- New York State Human Rights Law
- Equal Pay Provision
- Minimum Wage
- Wage Theft Prevention
- New York State Disability Statement of Rights (DB217S)
- Rights of Nursing Mothers to Express Breast Milk in the Work Place
- Child Labor Law - permitted working hours
- Prohibition of Employer Retaliation
- Time Off and Work Hours Notice
- Time Off to Vote Poster
- Workers' Compensation Notice - Inc.
- Workers' Compensation Notice - Federal
- City of New York City
 - Workers' Bill of Rights

- Safe and Sick Leave and Notice(<https://www.nyc.gov/assets/dca/downloads/pdf/about/PaidSafeSickLeave-MandatoryNotice-English.pdf>)
- Employers calendar year is Jan 1 - Dec 31st.

North Carolina

- Certificate of Coverage and Notice to Workers as to Benefit Rights
- Wage and Hour Notice to Employees

North Dakota

- Minimum Wage Work Conditions Summary

Ohio

- Child Labor Poster
- Equal Employment Opportunity Poster
- Minimum Wage
- Unemployment Compensation - Notice to Employees
- Workers' Compensation Rebuttal Presumption of Drug/Alcohol Use

Oklahoma

- Child Labor Law
- Oklahoma Law Prohibits Discrimination in Employment
- Minimum Wage Act
- Unemployment Insurance Benefits
- Workers' Compensation Notice - Inc.

Oregon

- Breaks and Overtime
- Equal Pay
- Family Leave Act
- Minimum Wage
- Oregon Occupational Safety and Health Administration
- Protections for Victims of Domestic Violence, Harassment, Sexual Assault and Stalking
- Sick Time
- Oregon OSHA's COVID-19 Standard for all Workplaces
- Workplace Accommodations Notice
- Paid Leave Notice Poster

Pennsylvania

- Minimum Wage Law
- Abstract of Equal Pay Law
- Employment Provisions of the PA Human Relations Act
- Abstract of the PA Child Labor Act
- Know Your Rights

- Worker's Compensation Poster
- Workers' Compensation Notice - Federal
- Workers' Compensation Notice - Inc.
- Allegheny County, PA
 - Paid Sick Leave Ordinance
- City of Philadelphia
 - Promoting Healthy Families and Workplaces
 - Fair Chance Hiring Law
 - Paid or Unpaid Sick Leave
 - Paid or Unpaid Sick Leave in Various Languages
- City of Pittsburgh
 - Paid Sick Days Act

Puerto Rico

- "SINOT"
- El Discrimen es Ilegal
- Carta de Derecgis de ka Mujer Trabajadora
- Normas del Trabajo
- Seguro Social
- Ley de Seguridad y Salud en el Trabajo en Puerto Rico

Rhode Island

- Rhode Island Combination Poster
- Discrimination is Illegal
- Notice of Right to be Free From Discrimination Because of Pregnancy, Childbirth and Related Conditions
- Sexual Harassment
- Workers' Compensation Notice - Inc.
- Sick and Safe Leave

South Carolina

- SC Labor Law Abstract
- SC Workplace Laws: Notice to Employees
- Workers' Compensation Notice - Federal
- Workers' Compensation Notice - Inc.

South Dakota

- South Dakota

Tennessee

- TOSHA Safety and Health Poster
 - Spanish
- Unemployment Insurance Poster
 - Spanish
- Wage Regulation/Child Labor Poster

- Spanish
- Discrimination in Employment is Illegal
- Human Trafficking Poster
- Right to Work Poster
- Fraud Free Workplace
- Workers' Compensation Notice - Inc.
- Workers' Compensation Notice - Federal

Texas

- Payday Law Poster
- Unemployment Compensation Act
- Equal Employment Opportunity
- Child Labor Laws
- Wage Claims
- Workers' Compensation Notice - Federal
- Workers' Compensation Notice - Inc.

Utah

- Pregnancy and Related Conditions Poster
- Workplace Safety and Health
- Unemployment Notice
- Workers' Compensation Notice - Federal
- Workers' Compensation Notice - Inc.

Vermont

- Unemployment Benefits
- Accommodations for Pregnant Employees
- Child Labor Poster
- Earned Sick Time
- Healthcare Whistleblower Poster
- Minimum Wage
- Parental and Family Leave
- Sexual Harassment Poster
- Workers Compensation Reinstatement Rights
 - GitLab has complied with the provisions of Title 21 of the Vermont Statutes, Annotated §687, by obtaining Workers' Compensation Insurance coverage through The Hartford.
- Employment Protections for Victims of Crime

Virginia

- Virginia Unemployment Compensation Act
- Virginia Occupational Safety and Health Act
- Earned Income Tax Credit
- Virginia CLI
- Workers' Compensation Notice
- Seizure First Aid Poster
- Workers' Compensation Notice - Federal

- Workers' Compensation Notice - Inc.

Washington

- Paid Family and Medical Leave
- Job Safety and Health Law
- Your Rights as a Worker
- Notice to Employees if a Job Injury Occurs
- Unemployment notice
- City of Seattle
 - Seattle Labor Standard Ordinances
- City of Tacoma
 - Paid Sick Leave

Washington D.C

- Accrued Sick and Safe Leave Act of 2008
- Paid Family Leave
- Minimum Wage
- Living Wages Act
- Building Services Act
- Universal Wage Law

West Virginia

- Minimum Wage Requirements
- Wage Payment and Collection Act
- WV Human Rights Act
- Unemployment Benefits Claimant Handbook

Wisconsin

- Employee Rights Under Wisconsin's Business Closing/Mass Layoff Notification Law
- Hours and Times of Day Minors May Work in Wisconsin
- Employee Protections Against Use of Honesty Testing Devices
- Fair Employment Law
- Family and Medical Leave Act
- Bone Marrow and Organ Donation Leave Act
- Minimum Wage Rates
- Notification Required for Cessation of Health Care Benefits
- Notice to Employees about Applying for Unemployment Benefits
- Workers' Compensation Notice - Inc.

Wyoming

- Consolidated Labor Law Posters

EEOC (U.S. Equal Employment Opportunity Commission) Notices

- "EEO is the Law - Know Your Rights: Workplace Discrimination is Illegal" English poster for

screen readers

- "EEO is the Law - Know Your Rights: Workplace Discrimination is Illegal" English poster for printing
- "EEO is the Law - Know Your Rights: Workplace Discrimination is Illegal" Spanish poster for printing
- "EEO is the Law" English Poster Supplement
- "EEO is the Law" Spanish Poster Supplement
- All "EEO is the Law - Know Your Rights: Workplace Discrimination is Illegal" poster links poster links.

E-Verify

- Notice of E-Verify Participation Poster
- Right to Work Poster

Employee Polygraph Protection Act

- EPPA Poster

Employee Rights on Government Contracts

- Employee Rights on Government Contracts (SCA, PCA, CWHSSA, Walsh- Healey)

Employee Rights under NLRA

- Employee Rights Under the National Labor Relations Act (one-page Poster)
- Employee Rights Under the National Labor Relations Act (two-page Poster)

Fair Labor Standards Act (FLSA) Minimum Wage

- Fair Labor Standards Act Poster
- Employee Rights for Workers with Disabilities Paid at Special Minimum Wages
- Lactation Accommodation Policy

Family First Coronavirus Act (FFCRA)

- Employee Rights: Paid Sick Leave and Expanded Family and Medical Leave under the Family First Coronavirus Act
- Essential Protections During the COVID-19 Pandemic

Family and Medical Leave Act

- Family and Medical Leave Act (FMLA) Poster

Federal Minimum Wage for Contractors Poster

- Worker Rights Under Executive Order 13658: Federal Minimum Wage for Contractors Poster

OSHA Job Safety and Health

- Job Safety and Health: It's the Law Poster

Pay Transparency Nondiscrimination Provision

- Pay Transparency Nondiscrimination Provision

Paid Sick Leave for Federal Contractors

- Worker Rights Under Executive Order 13706: Paid Sick Leave for Federal Contractors

Service Contract Act

- Service Contract Act

Your Rights Under USERRA

- Your Rights Under the Uniformed Services Employment and Reemployment Rights Act
{{% /details %}}

{{% details summary="GitLab Canada Corp." %}}

Ontario

- Employment Standards in Ontario
- Occupational Health & Safety Poster
- Occupational Health & Safety Act

British Columbia

- Working in B.C.
- Occupational Health and Safety Regulation
- Workers Compensation Act

Alberta

- Workers Compensation Act
- Employment Standards Code

Manitoba

- Safe Work Manitoba
{{% /details %}}

{{% details summary="GitLab BV" %}}

Netherlands

- European Agency for Safety and Health at Work - Netherlands
- OSH - Netherlands
- Health and Safety at Work - Netherlands

Finland

- Mehiläinen Occupational Health Service Provider
 - OmaMehiläinen mobile application and online service.
- {{% /details %}}

{{% details summary="GitLab GmbH" %}}

Germany

- European Agency for Safety and Health at Work
 - Working Hours Act
- {{% /details %}}

SECTION: labor-and-employment-notice/offboarding-documents.md

GitLab, Inc. & GitLab Federal LLC

Pointing you to this handbook page serves as our mechanism to provide the required notice(s) to you. Please find your specific State (if applicable) to access these notices. For any questions, please contact people-connect@gitlab.com.

{{% details summary="GitLab, Inc. & GitLab Federal LLC" %}}

Alabama

- Unemployment Compensation Documents

Alaska

- Unemployment Notice of Separation
- Unemployment Insurance Poster

Arizona

- Take Care of Unemployment Business UIB-1241A
- Unemployment Insurance Poster

Arkansas

- Unemployment Insurance Information Handbook

California

- Notice to Employees as to Change in Relationship
- For Your Benefit: CA's Programs for the Unemployed DE 2320
- DHCS Notice to Terminating Employee

Colorado

- Notice of Potential Availability of Unemployment Insurance Benefits
- Unemployment Insurance Poster

Connecticut

- Termination Notice
- Unemployment Notice UC-61

Georgia

- Separation Notice DOL-800

Illinois

- What Every Worker Should Know About Unemployment Insurance CLI-111L
- Unemployment Insurance Poster

Indiana

- Unemployment Insurance Poster

Iowa

- Notice of Separation 60-0154
- Important Resources on Unemployment

Kansas

- Service Letter (if requested): Contact people-connect@gitlab.com

Louisiana

- Notification to Employees of the Availability of Unemployment Compensation
- Separation Notice LWC 77

Maine

- Employment Security Law Poster
- Reason for Termination Letter (if requested): Contact people-connect@gitlab.com

Maryland

- Unemployment Compensation Availability Letter

Massachusetts

- Unemployment Insurance Benefits Claims Notice 0590-A
- Unemployment Insurance Poster

Michigan

- Unemployment Compensation Notice to Employee UIA 1711

Minnesota

- Reason for Termination Letter (if requested): Contact people-connect@gitlab.com.

Missouri

- Service Letter (if requested): Contact people-connect@gitlab.com
- Unemployment Insurance Benefits M-INF-288-5

Nebraska

- Unemployment Insurance Poster

Nevada

- Employer Notification to Employees of the Availability of Unemployment Compensation DETR-ESD
- Unemployment Insurance Poster

New Jersey

- Unemployment Benefits Claim BC-10

New York

- Unemployment Insurance Record of Employment IA 12.3
- Unemployment Assistance NY State site

Pennsylvania

- Unemployment Compensation UC-1609

Rhode Island

- Unemployment Insurance Notice

South Carolina

- Notification of the Availability of Unemployment Insurance Benefits.pdf)

South Dakota

- Reemployment Assistance (formerly Unemployment Insurance) Poster

Tennessee

- Employer Notification to Employees of the Availability of Unemployment Compensation LB-0489

Vermont

- Unemployment Insurance Poster

Washington

- Unemployment Benefits Poster

West Virginia

- Unemployment Claimant Handbook

{{% /details %}}

SECTION: leadership/_index.md

This page contains leadership pointers.

The first couple of headers indicate which group they apply to, using the groupings defined on our team structure page.

Managers of One

In an all-remote organization, we want each team member to be a manager of one. A manager of one is an attribute associated with our Efficiency value. To be successful at GitLab, team members need to develop their daily priorities to achieve goals. Managers of one set the tone for their work, assign items and determine what needs to get done. No matter what role you serve, self-leadership is an essential skill needed to be successful as a manager of one.

1. At GitLab, leadership is requested from everyone, whether an individual contributor or member of the leadership team.

1. As a leader, GitLab team members will follow your behavior, so always do the right thing. Lead by example with effort.

1. Everyone who joins GitLab should consider themselves ambassadors of our values and protectors of our culture.

1. Behavior should be consistent inside and outside the company. We do the right thing outside the company, too.

1. GitLab respects your judgment of what is best for you, since you know yourself best. If you have a better opportunity somewhere else don't stay at GitLab out of a sense of loyalty to the company.

1. In tough times people will put in their best effort when they are doing it for each other.

1. We work asynchronously. Lead by example and make sure people understand that things need to be written down in issues as they happen. Hold your team accountable with documentation.

1. We are not a democratic or consensus driven company. People are encouraged to give their comments and opinions, but in the end one person decides the matter after they have listened to all the feedback.

1. It is encouraged to disagree and have constructive debates but please argue intelligently.

1. We value truth seeking over cohesion.

1. We avoid meetings, when possible, because they don't support the asynchronous work flow and are hard to conduct due to timezone differences.

1. Start meetings on time, be on time yourself, don't ask if everyone is there, and don't punish people that have shown up on time by waiting for people or repeating things for those that come late. When a meeting unblocks a process or decision, don't celebrate that but instead address the question: How can we unblock in the future without needing a meeting?
1. Be intentional in how you prepare for and participate in meetings. Async communication works best when folks review their calendars and prepare in advance of meetings.
1. We give feedback, lots of it. Don't hold back on suggestions for improvements, this helps us grow. Take pride in helping others through feedback.
1. Focus on improvement. If you meet external people, always ask what they think we should improve.
1. Following from Paul Graham's advice: Strive to make the organization simpler.
1. Saying something to the effect of "as you might have heard", "unless you've been living in a cage you know", "as everyone knows", or "as you might know" is toxic. The people that know don't need it to be said. The people that don't know feel like they missed something and might be afraid to ask about the context.
1. Don't use someone else's name, remind people of your title, or otherwise "pull rank" to get things done.
1. Act as a CEO of yourself and your role by taking responsibility to set goals and appropriate timelines. Prioritize your contributions and know it's impossible to know everything.
1. Communicate clearly with your team and people leader on the status of your goals. Act quickly to address areas that pose a challenge or to reassess goals that cannot be reached in an allotted timeframe.

Examples of actions from managers of one at GitLab

1. When asked to attend a synchronous brainstorming call, a team member instead opens an issue and requests for their team's ideas asynchronously.
1. A people leader champions our value of Diversity, Inclusion and Belonging by becoming a mentor.
1. A team member blocks out dedicated time for learning and development to implement a regular practice of self-serving and self-learning.
1. A team member in a new role finds an inefficiency in a process they are learning. Without being asked or supervised, they open a merge request (MR) proposing a change and assign it to their manager for review.
1. When a scheduled meeting agenda is complete 10 minutes before the call is set to end, an attendee ends the call early.
1. A people leader hires a new team member that demonstrates our CREDIT values.
1. Before asking for others' time to discuss a topic, they dedicate time to process their thoughts and make a proposal.
1. A manager of one prioritizes well-being by blocking their calendars for fitness, meals, paid time off, and personal appointments.
1. A team member surfaces blockers as opposed to assuming their manager or team is already aware, and simultaneously works to unblock others by working in public and with a low level of shame.

Interim and Acting Leadership

In some cases, a individual in the Management group, Director group, S-group, or even E-group may have an "Interim" or "Acting" title.

1. Acting means that someone is occupying this role temporarily and will move back to their original role after a set amount of time or other conditions, such as an external hire.

1. Interim means the individual is working on a promotion into the role.

In either case, they will be fulfilling the full responsibilities of the role. If you have any questions, about the future of the role, please ask them or their manager.

Individual departments will have their own criteria for who is eligible to occupy these roles, so please check the career development page for your department.

Making decisions

Please see the Making Decisions Leadership page.

Communication should be direct, not hierarchical

Most companies communicate from top to bottom through a chain of command. This communication flow often empowers managers, but it also introduces inefficiency as team members are not able to connect directly with the people they need to communicate with in order to get their work done. At GitLab, every team member is encouraged to reach out to whoever is the correct person (or people) to quickly unblock issues, solve problems or support in other ways. Do be courteous of your direct manager and copy them on the request. We don't encourage unnecessary friction in asking team members to escalate through managers and wait for responses to come back. What matters is efficiency in getting to results. Slack the CEO, Slack a VP, or Slack a peer. Do what you need to do to make GitLab successful.

Managers should not be bottlenecks or silos for communication.

Anyone should feel comfortable reaching out to anyone else with the best information they can to solve a problem.

This is a more efficient, transparent, and collaborative way to work.

Giving Feedback

Giving regular feedback is extremely important for both managers and team members. Feedback can take the form of coaching sessions, separate from 1-to-1 meetings. Giving feedback is also about being prepared and, depending on the situation, you should create separate agendas and structure them as follows:

1. Provide context.

1. Use a framework for your feedback. Our recommended framework is Crucial Conversations -- we offer a training course, and the book is part of our recommended reading for leaders.

1. Ask yourself, is this:

- Actionable
- Specific
- Kind (Does the feedback help the person? Note: Being kind is not the same as being nice.)
- Objective (similar to Fair)
- Relevant to the job role and compa ratio

Identifying root causes

Sometimes when performance dips, the best way to tackle it is to try to determine the root cause. This is easier said than done. There is a great tool that CEB (now Gartner) created to help with this called performance issue root cause diagnostic. It may not always be possible or appropriate to determine the root cause, so the underperformance process should be followed.

Responding to Negative Feedback

As a leader, the way you respond to negative feedback makes a significant impact on your team. Remember that it can be difficult for people to approach someone in authority with concerns and respond with sensitivity and appreciation. In particular, we recommend that you keep the following in mind:

- Don't argue or get defensive. Accept the feedback for what it is: an attempt to help you improve your work or your professional relationships. If you do have to explain yourself, try to remain empathetic.
- It's fine (even preferable) to defer action. When presented with negative feedback, we often feel like we have to either justify our actions or promise change, and since change isn't always easy when you're responsible for a large team, justification becomes the default. It's OK to say you need time to evaluate the feedback and decide how to proceed.
- The Right Way to Respond to Negative Feedback
- If a team member from your department or another part of the org comes to you and says they do not feel like they or their reports' contributions are valued by your reports, the manager should try to resolve this. Research shows that this is more likely to happen to underrepresented minorities. Please note that DRIs are free to ignore feedback without acknowledging it and that valuing contributions isn't the same as agreeing with them. This is about co-opting someone else's idea without attribution and/or dismissing an idea with an ad-hominem remark.

1-to-1

Please see 1-1.

Skip level interactions

Please see skip-levels.

Your Individual README

A team member's README page is intended to help others understand what it might be like to work with them, especially people who haven't worked with them before. It's also a well-intentioned effort at building some trust by being intentionally vulnerable, and to share your ideas of a good working relationship, to reduce the anxiety of people who may be on your team, now or in the future.

READMEs provide a genuine report on how a person works, reducing bias/assumption and enabling people to work together based on a common framework. As part of GitLab's transparency value, we encourage each GitLab team member to consider creating their own README.

READMEs by Division

GitLab division README pages are linked below for context. Reading other READMEs is an important way to get ideas on what you can include in yours. Let these serve as a guide and inspiration to you.

- Engineering READMEs
- Marketing Team READMEs
- Product READMEs
 - UX Department READMEs
- Sales Team READMEs
- People Group READMEs
- Finance Team READMEs
- Legal Team READMEs
- Office of the CEO READMEs

Creating Your README

1. Copy the README-template and paste into your favorite Markdown editor. If you do not have a Markdown editor, Typora and Bear are recommended.

1. Fill out the recommended sections. Note that each section is optional. You can remove those you aren't comfortable filling out, and add sections that are interesting or important to you.

1. Once complete, you'll need to create an issue with the Digital Experience team to add a page to GitLab's website.

1. If your division already has a page to host READMEs (see above), follow the guidelines to add a new page within that directory (e.g. Darren M., a member of the marketing team, would add a new directory and page within /handbook/marketing/readmes, creating /handbook/marketing/readmes/dmurph)

1. If your division does not yet have a holding page for READMEs, follow the guidelines to add a new page (readmes) within your division's handbook section first, then create your username directory within readmes.

1. Bonus points if you add your README & yourselves as codeowner to the .gitlab/CODEOWNERS file.

Alternatively you can create your README dogfooding GitLab's README profile customization feature. Follow documentation on how to add details to your GitLab profile with a README. Do not forget to add your profile's link to you division's holding page.

Advertising Your README

Once your README is created, consider adding a link to it from following places:

- Google Doc agendas or calendar invites
- Your GitLab.com profile
- Your Slack profile
- Your Email signature

This provides maximum visibility to others, so that they may read your README in advance of working with you. This allows them to take your working style and communication preferences into account, ideally increasing the overall level of empathy expressed.

READMEs are particularly powerful when working with those outside of GitLab, who may be

unfamiliar with our values. A README is a beacon of transparency, and helps set the tone for any working relationship.

Coaching

What is coaching?

Coaching is about helping others help themselves. It is not about giving advice, instruction, or telling someone what to do. Coaching is about focusing on the future and identifying where the coachee wants to be and what they want to achieve. At GitLab, we've defined coaching as a conversation that helps people think for themselves, find their own answers, and commit to action they design. As a coach, your role is to clarify the pathway from the current state to the future. Coaches do this by enabling the coachee to make informed choices based on deeper insight.

No matrix organization

Please see [no-matrix-organization](#)

Stable counterparts

We want to promote organic cross-functional collaboration by giving people stable counterparts for other functions they need to work with. For example, each Strategic Account Executive (SAE) works with one Sales Development Representative (SDR). With our categories every backend team of developers maps to a Product Manager (PM) and a frontend team.

Giving people a stable counterpart allows for more social trust and familiarity, which speeds up decision making, prevents communication problems, and reduces the risk of conflicts. This way we can work effectively cross functionally without the downsides of a matrix organization.

Factory vs. studio

We want the best combination of a factory and a studio. The studio element means anyone can chime in about anything, from a user to the CEO. You can step outside your work area and contribute. The factory element means everyone has a clearly assigned task and authority.

Effective escalations

Team members should feel comfortable escalating issues when help is needed to resolve unexpected challenges. Effective escalations are good, because they speed up decision making. When team members escalate an issue, another person is brought in as a decision maker or adviser as other team members disagree or need help with alignment or a serious trade-off is needed. Escalation can offer clarity and a path forward, and can be a sign of seniority for the person initiating the escalation when they know what, how, and when to escalate.

As noted in this [medium article](#), explicit escalation should answer these four questions:

1. Why is this important to the person/team I'm escalating to?
1. What are the relevant details of the challenge?
1. What have you tried?

1. What do you need?

Folks who are escalating an issue should avoid surprising folks in the management chain. This means that other relevant team members should be aware that an escalation is occurring. For example, in E-Group, members agree that they will not go to the CEO with an escalation without first notifying other relevant members that this is happening.

There may be some exceptions to first notifying managers or peers. For example, a team member feels unsafe in voicing a concern to a manager or their peers and feels that they can't effectively escalate with standard notification without retribution. While exceptions may be appropriate, they should be rare.

After a team member escalates an issue, it is OK if they disagree, commit, and advocate with the decisions made by the person they escalated to.

Process gets a bad rep

Process has a bad reputation. It has that reputation for things that we try to avoid doing at GitLab. When you have processes that are not needed it turns into a bureaucracy. A good example are approval processes. We should keep approval processes to a minimum, by both giving people the authority to make decisions by themselves and by having a quick lightweight approval process where needed.

But process also has good aspects. Having a documented process for how to communicate within the company greatly reduces time spend on on-boarding, increases speed, and prevents mistakes. A counterintuitive effect is that it also makes it easier to change processes. It is really hard to change a process that doesn't have a name or location and lives in different versions in the heads of people. Changing a written process and distributing the diff is much easier.

Talent Acquisition and retention

Managers have an tremendous responsibility around talent acquisition and retention of team members.

- Voluntary departures should be low, especially unexpected ones. The most common reasons for resignations can be tied back to the manager.
- We want few candidates to decline an offer, especially when the reason isn't compensation.
- We need adequate candidate pipeline volume and quality, especially for crucial positions.
- Candidates that have a proposed offer should meet the bar, especially for more senior positions.
- Build a global team. Unless shown with a business case, "we can't find the talent out of the bay" goes against our diversity, inclusion and belonging mission and the Location Factor KPI.

High Output Management

GitLab leadership and management approach was built using principles covered in the book "High Output Management." Please see High Output Management to learn more.

Building High Performing Teams

Building a team to deliver results is a very important aspect of improving efficiency and iteration. A high-performing team will always deliver results. As a leader at GitLab, your role is to develop a high-performing team to reach the desired level of performance and productivity. There are certain traits that high-performing teams display at GitLab:

- Have a clear vision of their objectives and goals
- Stay committed to achieving their goals
- Manage conflicts
- Maintain effective communication and a healthy relationship with each other
- Make unanimous decisions as a team

Watch the replay of our conversation with Jeb Hurley, Co-founder and Managing Partner Brainware Partners where we discussed:

1. Managing trust, productivity, and well-being on remote teams
1. Behavior, biochemistry, and dynamics of trust
1. The value of measuring and reporting on impacts of building trust

{{< youtube "te3ZfJgFRxI" >}}

Skills and behavior of building high performing teams competency for Managers:

- Models and encourages teamwork by fostering collaboration, communication, trust, shared goals, mutual accountability and support
- Fosters an environment where results are balanced with time management of multiple assignments and Direct Responsible Individuals (DRI's) on important topics
- Empowers team members to be a Manager of One and gives them the tools to grow professionally in their careers
- Attracts and retains top talent by creating an inclusive environment built on trust, delegation, accountability, and teachability

Strategies to Build High Performing Teams

The Drexler-Sibbet Team Performance Model is an excellent tool to help build high performing teams at GitLab. The model provides a roadmap for a team and a common language. It is a simplified description of how a team works together that highlights the most important things the team needs to focus on to reach high performance. At GitLab, we can use it as a frame of reference to developing high performing teams. It can help Managers ensure new and existing team members know the mission and direction of the team by the following:

- To form your team
- To guide what your team does
- To monitor how well your team is doing
- To diagnose where your team may be struggling or identify the keys to your team's success.

7 Stages to developing high performing teams:

1. Orientation - Why are we here? Team members need to see a sense of team identity and how individual team members fit in.
1. Trust Building - Who are you? Team members share mutual regard for each other and are open

and supportive of trust-based relationships.

1. Goal Clarification - What are we doing? Assumptions are made clear; individual assumptions are made known with a clear vision of the end state.
1. Commitment - How will we do it? Team members understand how it will make decisions and do the work.
1. Implementation - Who does what, when, where? Team members have a sense of clarity and can operate effectively due to the alignment of shared goals.
1. High Performance - Wow! The team is accomplishing more than it expected. The team has taken off, creativity is fostered and goals are surpassed.
1. Renewal - Why continue? The team is given recognition and celebrates achievements of individuals that produce valuable work. Reflect on lessons learned and reassess for the future.

Manager Resource: Identifying & Addressing Burnout

Building and maintaining high performance includes staying mindful of team well-being and potential burnout. With GitLab's results-driven culture, the demands of product innovation around AI, the fast-paced and ever-evolving business environment, our organization recognizes the crucial balance between achieving ambitious goals and maintaining the well-being of our team members. Everyone can access this handbook resource designed for managers to identify & address burnout. This has an ongoing impact on team performance.

Manager M-Team Groups

M-teams are management support groups made up of 3 to 6 managers who are in timezones that allow for sync meetings among members. M-teams should set up a regular meeting on a cadence agreed by the members with the agenda being "what's challenging this week?". Decide who will facilitate and each person will get a chance to have their challenge discussed in the meeting. When it's your turn, you talk a little about what you're struggling with. M-groups agree to a level of confidentiality so that group members are willing to be vulnerable; vulnerability leads to trust and better outcomes for the group.

If you're interested in starting or joining an m-team meeting, reach out to other managers in the managers Slack channel.

Articles

1. Carta's Manager's FAQ
1. Carta's How to hire
1. How Facebook Tries to Prevent Office Politics
1. The Management Myth
1. Later Stage Advice for Startups
1. Mental Models I Find Repeatedly Useful
1. This Is The Most Difficult Skill For CEOs To Learn
1. Great article about how to think about PIPs, although our time scales are shorter.
1. Impraise Blog: 1-on-1s for Engaged Employees
1. Mind Tools: Giving Feedback: Keeping Team Member Performance High, and Well Integrated
1. Remote.Co: 5 Tips for Providing Feedback to Remote Workers
1. Really interesting blog post from Hanno on remote team feedback
1. 51 questions to ask in one-on-ones with a manager
1. HBR: The rise of data driven decision making is real but uneven

1. Forbes: 6 Tips for Making Better Decisions

Books

Books in this section can be expensed.

Notable books from the E-Group Offsite Book Selections may be added to the list below.

We sometimes self-organize book clubs to read through these books as a group.

1. High Output Management - Andrew Grove

- Top 10 quotes
- Book club

1. The Hard Thing About Hard Things: Building a Business When There Are No Easy Answers - Ben Horowitz

- Chase Wright's notes

1. Crucial Conversations: Tools for Talking When Stakes Are High - Kerry Patterson

- Notes from the E-group reading:
- Virtual teams are much more likely to fail on crucial conversations than colocated teams
- We need to develop the skill of sensing the tone of a-sync conversations to uncover potential issues
- We need to find a way to create psychological safety for people in official channels
- Starting with empathy is a great way to gather the context needed in a tense situation - this is hard a-sync, but more important
- Consider getting context 1-on-1 (through Slack) before posting a comment in an issue that you might regret later
- As leaders, we need to give context as well. A good question is: "What would have to change for us to get X prioritized..."
- Documenting something is not a replacement for having the hard conversation
- Book club
- Crucial Conversations Handbook Page

Email Lists

1. Software Lead Weekly

Training

When you give leadership training please screen share the handbook instead of creating a presentation.

Leadership Development Opportunities

1. Managers can participate in our Elevate program, focused on developing management skills to lead all-remote teams.

1. Leadership development coaching with the growth & development benefit. More details about a formal GitLab coaching program to come.

1. Self-led opportunities to be a mentor - keep an eye out for a company-wide mentorship program with applications opening at the end of January 2022.

1. Join the women's TMRG mentorship group to either be a mentor to practice leadership or get

paired with a leader to learn from.

1. Sign up for Crucial Conversations training

1. Explore opportunities to join the CEO Shadow program or other division specific shadow programs with the Chief of Staff, and Security.

1. Explore the skills needed to successfully transition from IC to Manager in GitLab Learn.

1. Explore leadership and management courses on LinkedIn Learning

1. Learning and Development is developing several programs in FY23 to include a Managing at GitLab Course, New Manager Bootcamp, LifeLabs Learning Pilot and Launch, coaching program, and much more!

People Group

Feel free to reach out to anyone in the People Group for further support on leadership development topics. You can find us on the team page, using the People Group dropdown. The team may also be reached via HelpLab.

Being a public company

Learn more on GitLab's view of being a public company.

Mitigating Concerns

We have a page which documents our Mitigating Concerns. Many of our values help to mitigate some of these concerns.

SECTION: leadership/biggest-tailwinds.md

We believe that the market opportunity for a complete DevSecOps platform designed as a single application for the software development lifecycle is several billion dollars and expanding%20i s, revenue%20per%20user%20(ARPU).&text=Additional%20potential%20users%3A, Product%20managers) There are three primary trends outlined below that we have identified as the most significant to supporting the long term success of our business.

We also have a Mitigating Concerns page.

1. Digital Transformation

Digital Transformation

Customer Experience

Software is Eating the World

2. DevOps

DevOps

Developers as the New Kingmakers

DevOps Tooling Consolidation

Lack of Developers

Open Source

3. Multicloud

Multicloud

Cloud Native and the Adoption of Kubernetes

Microservices

Observability

Progressive Delivery

Workloads Moving to the Cloud

4. All-Remote

All-Remote

GitLab's all-remote workforce is significantly more advanced and sophisticated than other forms of organizational design. Our dedication to working handbook-first, operating transparently, and usage of GitLab to drive results creates tailwinds for the organization.

GitLab's adherence to all-remote makes the company an attractive destination for people who are on the B-team in hybrid-remote firms, or feel limited by the inflexibility of a fully colocated role.

GitLab Guide to All-Remote

Work where you want, when you want

All-Remote Upgrade

Our Work-From-Anywhere Future

SECTION: leadership/book-clubs.md

From time to time, we run internal book clubs on a book from one of our resource lists. All are welcome! However, each club has a suggested audience to indicate roles to which the content is tailored.

- Leadership
- Development

To propose a new book club, create an issue in the book clubs project. Individual book clubs which need a dedicated project can create one in the book-clubs group (example).

Better Onboarding

- Dates: 2021-07-08 and 2021-07-15
- Time: 02:00 PM UTC
- Zoom (password is in the calendar event info)
- Meeting agenda
- Discussion issue
- Recording Session 1
- Recording Session 2
- Suggested audience: Growth, Product, Product Design and Development

Trustworthy Online Controlled Experiments (A Practical Guide to A/B Testing)

- Dates: 2021-03-11 to 2021-06-10 (every week)
- Time: 08:00 PT / 15:00 UTC
- Zoom (password is in the calendar event info)
- Meeting agenda
- Discussion issue
- Suggested audience: growth, product & engineering

Ruby under a Microscope

- Dates: 2020-11-24 to 2021-03-03 (every week)
- Time: EMEA 14:00 UTC, AMER/APAC 23:00 UTC
- Zoom EMEA, Zoom AMER/APAC (password is in the calendar event info)
- Meeting agenda
- Discussion issue
- Suggested audience: engineering

Software Engineering at Google

- Dates: 2020-05-20 to 2020-07-29 (every 2 weeks)
- Time: 21:30 UTC
- Zoom
- Meeting agenda
- Discussion issue
- Suggested audience: engineering management

The Principles of Product Development Flow

- Dates: 2019-09-05 to 2019-10-31 (every week)
- Time: 11:30 Pacific Time
- Zoom
- Meeting agenda
- Discussion issue
- Suggested audience: engineering management

High Output Management

- Dates: 2019-06-03 to 2019-07-15 (every two weeks)
- Time: 7:30 Pacific Time (one hour before the company call)
- Zoom
- Meeting agenda
- Discussion issue
- Recordings
- Suggested audience: people managers

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Crucial Conversations

This book club was internal-only.

- Dates: 2018-10-01 to 2018-11-05
- Notes
- Recordings
- Suggested audience: engineering managers

Suggestions on running a book club

1. If possible, find a partner. Having two people run the book club has a number of advantages:
 1. Reduced pressure and workload.
 1. Lower chance of needing to reschedule due to illness or other emergency.
 1. Meetings start as a conversation, not a monologue.
 1. Add your buddy as a co-host in Zoom so that meetings can be recorded in your absence
1. Add the book's title to the handbook if it isn't already listed.
 1. Books that are also available as audiobooks increase the potential audience. The more ways people can experience the book, the more people can attend.
1. Set up the meeting schedule.
 1. Record the meetings and post them to YouTube. If the participants agree, make the videos public.
 1. Consider having the same section of the book covered in different meeting slots, to allow people in different time zones to attend.
1. Set the expected reading schedule for the entire book before starting, so people know what level of reading is required.
1. Create an agenda for each session seeded with interesting quotes and concepts from the relevant section of the book.
 1. If possible, prepare topics for all of the sessions before the starting, too - although this requires the hosts to read the whole book up front.
1. Once the book club is done, seek feedback and update this handbook page!

SECTION: leadership/building-trust.md

Introduction

Trust is the cornerstone of how we operate at GitLab. We trust team members to do the right thing instead of having rigid rules. Trust at GitLab increases results, efficiency, and collaboration.

Trust takes time and energy to build. We leverage informal communication to build trust, but there are additional strategies people leaders and team members can implement on their teams.

Working remotely can be isolating for team members if managers do not take the necessary steps to build trust and social cohesion amongst their teams. In a remote environment, it can take team members longer to get to know each other compared to a colocated office setting. On this page, we've outlined additional strategies people leaders and team members can apply to build trust amongst their teams.

Ten Dimensions of Trust

Sid Sijbrandij, GitLab's co-founder, shared what he has identified as the ten dimensions of trust. He notes that trust allows you to assume positive intent in support of our CREDIT values. It also helps to prevent political behavior that runs counter to our values.

1. Optimizing efficiency for the right group
 1. We versus I optimization
 1. Organization versus individual
 1. Other teams versus your team
 1. Global versus territorial, kingdom building
1. Mindset
 1. Abundance
 1. Positive sum position instead of zero sum
 1. Open-minded
 1. Looking for creative win-win solutions
1. Familiarity
 1. Knowing the person better
 1. Listening (actively)
 1. Spending more time
 1. Informal communication
1. Information
 1. Providing and receiving feedback
 1. Bad news travels fast
 1. Transparency (show your intermediate work)
 1. Wide access to information, meetings, and meeting notes
1. Responsiveness
 1. Availability
 1. Open to suggestions
1. Confidentiality
 1. Respected

- 1. Safe space
 - 1. Negative in a small group, not large forums
 - 1. Discretion in what can be shared and when
- 1. Build
 - 1. Praise in a broader group
 - 1. Giving credit (for an idea)
 - 1. Constructively picking arguments (steel man vs. listening for weak arguments)
 - 1. Make each other better
 - 1. Explain the why (Simon Sinek)
 - 1. Celebrate successes
- 1. Competence
 - 1. Calibrated to what is required
 - 1. High standards
 - 1. Relentlessly resourceful
- 1. Consistency
 - 1. Opinion/behavior independent of who is in the room
 - 1. No backroom conversations
 - 1. No alliances, other than with all peers
 - 1. No politics (link to handbook section)
- 1. History
 - 1. Keeping commitments
 - 1. History of success

Strategies to Build Trust

People Leaders should make every effort to build trust as soon as they mobilize a team, when new team members start, and throughout the year. Informal communication is a great tool to build trust; however, there are additional strategies managers and team members can implement to build trust within the teams they support.

Personality Assessments

Getting to know your people through personality assessments is a tool to build trust. Personality assessments can help teams understand how they are different and enable managers to better understand their direct reports. The results can shine a light on ways you can adapt your processes in a way that is most effective for different team members. Remember when we use personality assessments, it is essential to not type-cast team members into their assessed personality results. Instead use them as a tool to facilitate more meaningful conversations amongst your team.

An abundance of free personality assessments are available. Several are outlined below:

- Understanding Social Styles
- Emotional Intelligence Assessments
- Gallup Strengths Finder
- 16 Personalities (also known as Myers-Briggs)
- DISC Personality Test
- HEXACO Personality Inventory

How to apply personality assessments: People leaders can have all team members take a

personality assessment when they first join their team. Managers can examine personality assessment results and have strength-based discussions with their people. However, it is essential to never type-cast team members based on their results. Use personality assessments as a tool to facilitate trust and get to know each other. When we embrace our unique strengths and the unique strengths of our team members, we all feel more engaged, more productive, more valued, and more trusted. They should encourage their team members to share their strengths / styles with the team. In addition, team members can take personality assessment and update their READMEs accordingly with personality assessment information if they choose to.

Use a One-Slider Personal Summary

A one-slider personal summary is a tool for remote teams to get to know one another. Consider using the template and example below as a starting point. The one-slider can be adapted to whatever questions or facts you'd like to learn more about. One-sliders allow team members to share fun facts about themselves in a remote setting. You can be creative and ask entertaining questions! When someone joins the team, have them fill out a one-slider and use it to introduce themselves to the team. They are fun, easy, and can help to build trust by getting to know one another in a remote setting.

How to apply one-sliders: Before the next team call, ask one or two members of the team to pre-populate a one-slider a day or two in advance of the meeting. Spend the first five to ten minutes of the meeting having the designated team members share their one-slider. Give everyone an equal amount of time and encourage everyone on the call to ask questions about what makes them unique.

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Optional Weekly Team Social Call

Optional social calls are a strategy to increase trust. Anyone can organize one. They are tools to come together as a team informally. The secret is to make the meeting non-work related. Attendees are able to share photos related to the topic during their time speaking. Example optional social call topics:

- Top three songs of all time (you can play short snippets of a song)
- Favorite foods
- Two truths and a lie
- If you won the lottery tomorrow, what would you do
- Would you rather
- What's the most exciting thing you've done outside of work this week/month
- Most recent or favorite vacation

How to apply optional weekly team social calls: Set a regular cadence of optional weekly team social calls (monthly, bi-weekly, weekly). Each social call, have one team member be in charge of managing and facilitating the discussion. They are responsible for proposing the topic and

keeping the call moving. Remember to make these fun and try not to talk about work!

To be inclusive of time zones and those who may not prefer these types of social settings, alternate synchronous social calls with asynchronous social standups. You can port the questions to the Geekbot Slack app so team members can share at their convenience.

Zoom Background Ice-Breaker

The Zoom feature to upload any background image of your choice is a fun tool to use for an ice breaker. Managers can ask their team to come to a meeting with a background of their favorite place to vacation, or a place they hope to visit one day, and much more. It's a great feature that can add some fun to calls and build unity. Spend the first five minutes of a meeting talking about the Zoom background and giving everyone in the meeting a voice.

One of our Managers said this about the Zoom Background Ice-Breaker:

> One of my favorite things that the team and I have done over the last 3-4 months is to update our Zoom background. We all threw out TV shows and then agreed on our favorite, from there; we picked a scene from that show and showed up to a meeting with our background. Not only was it fun to listen to the shows our team members like, but it was also a conversation piece and a lot of fun!

How to apply Zoom background ice-breakers: Team members can do this for as many meetings as they like. If it is a team discussion, spend the first five minutes of the meeting doing a round robin of the background. Managers can implement a rotation of DRIs (directly responsible individuals) in charge of the ice-breaker by assigning different team members.

Give Credit to Team Members

Use the 'thanks' Slack channel to give recognition to team members in a public setting. Review team accomplishments weekly, monthly, and quarterly. Meet with each team member to review their accomplishments.

Take a coaching approach and have the team members talk through what their accomplishments were. Managers should identify opportunities for executives to recognize the team. They should also look for opportunities to recognize the team in front of executives.

How to apply giving credit to team members: Managers can set a weekly reminder to review team accomplishments and areas for individual recognition. Scheduling a regular cadence of giving credit will show team members that leaders are playing an active role in their career.

1-1 Meetings

1-1 meetings can serve as an opportunity for managers and team members to get to know each other on a personal and professional level. Nobody is alike, and each person has a different unique background and story. A communication or management approach that works well on one team member might not work on another. By showing vulnerability during 1-1 discussions, team members can build trust.

How to build trust in 1-1 meetings: One way to do this is to ensure team members have plenty of

time to talk about the weekend or what fun things are going on in their lives. Managers can spend the first 5-10 minutes of the call, letting it be about "them." Before diving straight into "work topics," especially at the beginning of a new working relationship, pause and ask about family, hobbies, the weekend, etc. Try to remember things team members mention about family, pets, hobbies, or other things going on in their life. If they live in a particular part of the world, managers can spend time getting to know what's happening regionally. Follow up with questions related to a team member's home. For some great tips on how to make small talk and build connection through communication listen to Rachel Greenwald in Episode 89 of Think Fast, Talk Smart.

Leverage the Building High Performing Teams Model

The Building High Performing Teams model is one of the most widely used and accepted models for team development. A big component of the model is building t